

MOVIE

Hubie Halloween

★★★★☆ | 2019's Uncut Gems, if anything, went on to further, glamorously display the dynamic range and potential Adam Sandler has, when working under the right directors. Upon getting snubbed for a nomination at the Oscars, he had threatened to make a return to stupid comedies, and purposely create an absolute stinker of a film. Despite the fair warning, we still went into it.

Directed by Steven Brill, Hubie Halloween mainly revolves around Hubie Dubois (Adam Sandler), a good-mannered citizen of the town of Salem, who is a subject of mockery and constant bullying for kids and adults alike. On the spooky night of Halloween, this scaredy-cat finds himself in the midst of a real,



eerie investigation. Going into this film, you need to realise that it is meant to be sort of a cringy and goofy ride, where there are no serious implications. However, being self-aware of the foolishness does not cut it, as the overall film lacks

the obvious flair and humour. It is littered with silly, childish jokes based around poop, farts, puke and peeing, which have proven time and again, to always fail. Adding onto it is Adam's goofy voice and exaggerated screaming, which is supposed to "amplify" the humour (because "loud = funny"). But instead, it just keeps getting annoying as time passes by.

The structure and pacing of this film feels like a complete mess, owing to the numerous subplots that never seem to tie-in, until the very end. The casting for this film, despite being loaded and doing a fair job, was a pain to watch. The only glaring positive for this film would be the way it beautifully captures the essence of Halloween. From the costumes and ambience, to the lighting and cinematography, to even the soundtrack.

Overall, Hubie Halloween proves to be yet another bad comedy resulting from the Netflix x Sandler collab. There is just an overwhelming amount of tones and events going on in this film. But hey, for what it's worth - not boring!

COMIC

Dark Nights: Death Metal Rise of the New God

★★★★☆ | This is a bizarre new comic that features one of the most extreme versions of Batman, and is a part of the Death Metal event, which itself is a sequel to the Dark Nights: Metal. The framing story has a long history behind it, where Perpetua is out to destroy the realities in the multiverse, helped by various avatars of Batman, including the Batman who laughs who leads an army of Batmen that all work towards helping Perpetua realise her goals. Perpetua's idea is to destroy all creations and reforge them from scratch. In terms of a story, it has its ups and downs, losing many of the things



that make batman so compelling, perhaps because everything is so new and strange. But then again, it features the Batmansaurus Rex, which is a Batman that has turned into a cyborg T-Rex, so in terms of raw ideas, the event is really imaginative. After many twists and turns, we finally end up with a cosmic

confrontation, where Batman is taking on Perpetua, they are literally lobbing planets at each other. Seriously, this is Batman at his most powerful, and most evil, a giant beast monster hell bent on accelerating the ultimate demise of a failing and doomed multiverse. This epic confrontation is still the background for the actual story, which is that of the Chronicler, a being from a higher order in the cosmic hierarchy, the omniverse. The function of the Chronicler is to merely observe, record and remember, but through a series of interviews with The Joker, The Riddler, Psycho-Pirate and Vril Dox he is increasingly confronted with the complexities of the multiverse, and in his quest for understanding it better, he takes steps beyond what he is allowed. This journey of the chronicler culminates in a resurrection of Metron, who appeals to him to interfere, to prevent the destruction of all realities, with a passionate argument where he proves that the multiverse is immortal because of its memory. Yeah, it can be a bit hard to take in, so its just as fun to be exposed to the art and ideas.